Executive Functioning

Executive functioning is an umbrella term for cognitive process that regulate, control, and manage other cognitive processes, such as planning, problem solving, organization, and prioritizing. Executive functioning is regulated in the interior frontal lobe.

Metaphorically Speaking

- Executive functioning represents the "secretary" or "executive assistant" to the brain.
- When children have executive functioning issues, its like having a sleepy secretary.

Concerns

- Poor time management & self-organization.
- Less independence and self-reliance.
- Greater need for assistance and supervision by others.
- Impact on education.

Tips For Success

- Focus on developing habits and routines that eventually become automatic.
- Teach students to think about tasks and how to approach them.
- Structure and guidance can assist the process of skill remediation when efficient and practical strategies are taught to students.
- (Second Step Curriculum, Good Planning).
  - Fill out your daily planner.
  - Put it in your bag with your supplies.
  - Check it when you get home.
  - Do your homework.
  - Make sure you put your homework back in your bag.

Tips Continued

- Research shows that sleep is key. Lack of sleep can cause kids to be less alert and less productive (Around 9 hours).
- Create Lists
- Color-Coded Binders
- Recopying Notes
- Calendars
- Phone Alarms (Technology is wonderful).
- Limit Distractions
- Scaffolding
- Build Routines

“What separates a smart person from a successful student is hard work and perseverance.”